

CEO

Catherine Voss, Master of the Universe

CEO · EXECUTIVE



HIRE

◆ 5

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Requires a Financials funding source.

Once each turn, you may turn up to 3 Leverage into Surplus, one for one.

If you become insolvent, every other company loses 5 Surplus.

Advises both sides of every deal, bills them both, and knows the bailout number by heart.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 211 / 357

OFFICE LOCATION

New York

OFFICE LOCATION



OPEN

◆ 4 branch only

Litigation

Headquarters or Open as a branch.

The first Investment you play on your turn costs 1 less Leverage (minimum 1).

The deal closes before the lunch reservation does.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 333 / 357

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 357

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 357

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

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Staple: any number per deck.

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ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 357

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Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



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MARGIN

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NO. 036 / 357

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 357

FUNDING SOURCE

Private Credit

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1½ each turn

Carrying costs add up, then round down: one costs 1, two cost 3.

Patient money at an impatient rate.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 035 / 357

Private Credit

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1½ each turn

Carrying costs add up, then round down: one costs 1, two cost 3.

Patient money at an impatient rate.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 035 / 357

Private Credit

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1½ each turn

Carrying costs add up, then round down: one costs 1, two cost 3.

Patient money at an impatient rate.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 035 / 357

Margin Credit

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1 each turn

At the end of your turn, you can keep only 1 Margin Credit for every 10 Surplus you have. Discard the rest.

Your prime broker's favorite customer, right up until the collateral call.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 037 / 357

Margin Credit

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1 each turn

At the end of your turn, you can keep only 1 Margin Credit for every 10 Surplus you have. Discard the rest.

Your prime broker's favorite customer, right up until the collateral call.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 037 / 357

Retail Deposits

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Rates

Staple: any number per deck.

A third of your Retail Deposits, rounded down, have no exposure.

A bank run makes you discard half your Retail Deposits, Venture Deposits, and Evergreen Credit, rounded down.

Checking, savings, and a free toaster: the cheapest money in finance, until it all wants out at once.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 034 / 357

Retail Deposits

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Rates

Staple: any number per deck.

A third of your Retail Deposits, rounded down, have no exposure.

A bank run makes you discard half your Retail Deposits, Venture Deposits, and Evergreen Credit, rounded down.

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F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 034 / 357

Retail Deposits

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

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ALPHA EX MACHINA

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FINANCIALS



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NO. 034 / 357

Retail Deposits

FINANCIALS



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F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 034 / 357

Private Equity

ILLIQUID



COST

◆ 3

ILLIQUID

▲ Regulation

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Destroyed if a Liquidity Stress Test hits you.

No distributions yet, which the fund calls the J-curve.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 052 / 357

Dynamic Hedging Program

TREATY



COST

◆ 3

CARRYING COST

● 1 each turn

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Requires an Annuity or Financials funding source.

Halve your loss from Short-Term Equity, Long-Term Equity, and Volatility clauses (round down).

The hedge works perfectly, except when the market moves.

A

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 113 / 357

Research Analyst

FRONT LINE



HIRE

◆ 4

Requires a Financials funding source.

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Publishes forty pages a day, of which occasionally one is right.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 218 / 357

Trading Algorithm

SOFTWARE



PRICE

◆ 3

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Whenever a Market Stress Test resolves, gain 2 Surplus.

Destroyed if Flash Crash hits you.

Made money every second of the backtest, and for the first forty-five minutes of the real thing.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 351 / 357

Corporate Spy

FRONT LINE

DARK



HIRE

◆ 2

DARK

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile.

Each opponent's maximum hand size is 1 lower.

Badge says Facilities, laptop says otherwise.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 207 / 357

Margin Call

LIQUIDITY



COST

◆ 3

HITS

Target opponent

ESCALATE

▲ Liquidity ▲ Volatility

Escalate: pay 2 more to hit every opponent instead.

Target opponent loses 4 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 2 per Volatility exposure, and 2 per investment they control.

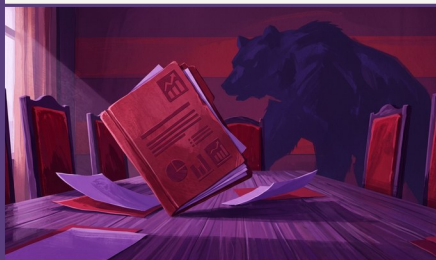
The broker would like a word, and also your cash.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 268 / 357

Short-Seller Report

REPUTATION



COST

◆ 3

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent loses 2 Surplus per investment they control and 1 per Dark card on their board, plus 4 more.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Blockchain Co. it controls.

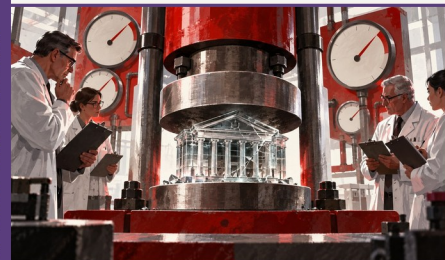
Ninety-four pages, a catchy name, and a very bad morning for investor relations.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 271 / 357

Supervisory Stress Test

REGULATION



COST

◆ 3

HITS

Target opponent

▲ Credit ▲ Liquidity

Target opponent loses 5 Surplus per Credit exposure, 3 per Liquidity exposure, and 1 per Dark card on their board. Then they can't add a funding source on their next turn.

The regulators ran their annual stress test, and this year you were the stress.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 298 / 357

Whistleblower

CORPORATE



COST

◆ 2

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent loses 6 Surplus per Dark card in their discard pile.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Shell Company, Feeder Fund, Affiliate Loan, or Guaranteed Returns Fund it controls.

She kept copies of everything, including the email telling her not to.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 291 / 357

M&A Advisory

ILLIQUID



COST

◆ 3

YIELD

● 2 each turn

SIGNATURE ILLIQUID

▲ Long-Term Equity

Signature: one copy per deck; Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Destroyed if a Market Stress Test hits you.

Every merger is a match made in heaven, at least until the fees clear.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 079 / 357

Prime Brokerage

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 3

YIELD

● 2 each turn

SALE

2 any time

▲ Credit

Destroyed if a Liquidity Stress Test hits you.

Lends hedge funds the money to buy the stock that secures the loan.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 078 / 357

Data Center Loans

ILLIQUID



COST

◆ 3

YIELD

● 2 each turn

AI ILLIQUID

▲ Credit

AI: AI Bubble Bursts destroys it; Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Secured by a warehouse of chips and one tenant with a very bold revenue forecast.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 098 / 357

Trading Desk

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 3

YIELD

● 2 each turn

SALE

2 any time

▲ Short-Term Equity

Destroyed if a Market Stress Test hits you.

Buys low, sells high, and has a very good explanation for the other days.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 080 / 357

Off-Balance-Sheet Vehicle

COVER

DARK



COST

◆ 1

DARK SIGNATURE COVER

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile; Signature: one copy per deck; Cover: discard it if that card leaves play.

You may pay Surplus instead of Leverage to play this card.

Attach to one of your investments. Its exposures don't count.

Destroyed if Enron Implodes hits you.

It's not our debt, it's the box's. We just own the box, guarantee the box, and named it.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 147 / 357

Subsidiary CDS

TREATY



COST

◆ 1

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Requires a Financials funding source.

When Credit clauses cost you Surplus, regain up to 6 of it. Then discard this.

Destroyed if Restructuring hits you.

Protection on a subsidiary that, as of this morning, owes nobody anything.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 152 / 357

Creditor-on-Creditor-Violence Liability Management Exercise

CORPORATE



COST

◆ 3

HITS

Target opponent

ESCALATE

▲ Credit

Escalate: pay 2 more to hit every opponent instead.

Target opponent loses 3 Surplus per Credit exposure and 3 per investment they control.

The new lenders get the collateral, while the old lenders get a letter explaining what an unrestricted subsidiary is.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 302 / 357

Chicago

OFFICE LOCATION



OPEN

◆ 4 branch only

Headquarters or Open as a branch.

At the start of your turn, gain 1 Surplus for every 3 Equity Futures, Commodity Futures, or Interest-Rate Futures treaties you control, combined (round down).

The weather is volatile, so the book is hedged.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 339 / 357

INVESTMENT

Inverse VIX Note

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 5

YIELD

● 3 each turn

SALE

1 any time

▲ Volatility x2

Destroyed if Volmageddon hits you.

Collects small gains for staying short volatility, right up to one very large afternoon.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 097 / 357

PROGRAM

Equity Futures

TREATY



COST

◆ 0

While this is in play, 1 of your unhedged Short-Term Equity exposures counts as Liquidity instead. Each exposure can flip only once; earlier programs choose first. If none remain, this does nothing.

The market risk is covered, so please post collateral by the close.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 157 / 357

PROGRAM

Equity Futures

TREATY



COST

◆ 0

While this is in play, 1 of your unhedged Short-Term Equity exposures counts as Liquidity instead. Each exposure can flip only once; earlier programs choose first. If none remain, this does nothing.

The market risk is covered, so please post collateral by the close.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 157 / 357

TALENT

Headhunter

FRONT LINE



HIRE

◆ 3

Commit this employee to poach an opponent's employee. (Pay its Hire plus 2 Surplus. It gains Non-compete and arrives committed.)

Knows what everyone at your table is paid, and who would pay them more.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 222 / 357

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Asset Freeze

GEOPOLITICAL



COST

◆ 3

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent has one Investment to discard without Sale proceeds, chosen by the runner.

The position was marked at full value right up until the moment it could not be sold, moved, or mentioned.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 329 / 357

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Lease Terminated

CORPORATE



COST

◆ 2

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent has one branch to discard, chosen by the runner.

The building was sold to a developer with other plans, most of them involving condominiums.

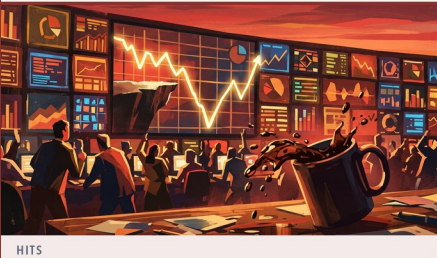
ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 332 / 357

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

Flash Crash

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2010



HITS

Every company from the pile

SIGNATURE

ACT OF GOD

▲ Short-Term Equity

▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Short-Term Equity exposure and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Meme Stock it controls.

On May 6, 2010, a burst of automated selling briefly wiped about a trillion dollars off the value of U.S. stocks. The Dow fell almost 1,000 points in minutes, then mostly came back.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 276 / 357

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

Election Year Reversal

REGULATION



HITS

Every company from the pile

▲ Regulation

▲ Health Price

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Regulation exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

Every four years, half the actuaries update their assumptions and the other half update their resumes.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 242 / 357

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

Volcker Shock

RATES · AS-IF REPLAY, 1979



HITS

Every company from the pile

SIGNATURE

▲ Short-Term Rates

▲ Liquidity

▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Short-Term Rates exposure, 2 per Liquidity exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

In October 1979 the Federal Reserve let short-term rates climb toward 20% to break inflation, and the savings and loans that had funded 30-year mortgages with passbook savings never recovered.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 295 / 357

1906 San Francisco Earthquake

NAT CAT · AS-IF REPLAY, 1906



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

SIGNATURE **ACT OF GOD**

▲ Nat Cat: Earthquake ▲ Property Value

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 12 Surplus per Nat Cat: Earthquake exposure and 4 per Property Value exposure.

On April 18, 1906, a magnitude 7.9 earthquake struck San Francisco, and the fires that followed burned for three days and destroyed most of the city.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 244 / 357

Subprime Meltdown

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2007



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

SIGNATURE

▲ Credit ▲ Property Value ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Credit exposure, 6 per Property Value exposure, and 3 per Volatility exposure.

In 2007 the adjustable-rate mortgages written with no income checks began to reset, and the loans bundled into AAA-rated bonds defaulted by the hundreds of thousands. The bonds' ratings were the last thing to go.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 297 / 357

Bird Flu Pandemic

MORTALITY



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

SIGNATURE **ACT OF GOD**

▲ Mortality ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Cat Bond - Mortality it controls.

Public health agencies have tracked the strain for years.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 234 / 357

Quantitative Easing

RATES



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

ACT OF GOD

▲ Low Interest Rates

Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Low Interest Rates exposure.

The central bank was very clear about its plans, which was the problem.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 243 / 357

Sinking of the Titanic

MORTALITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 1912



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

SIGNATURE

▲ Mortality

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Mortality exposure, plus 2 more.

In April 1912, the Titanic struck an iceberg on its first voyage and sank in the North Atlantic, and more than 1,500 people died.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 256 / 357

New Capital Standard

REGULATION



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

▲ Regulation

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Regulation exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Rated Feeder Note it controls.

Twelve years of consultation, three hundred pages of formulas, one very long weekend for the actuaries.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 280 / 357

Opioid Epidemic

MORTALITY



HITS

Every company *from the pile*

SIGNATURE

▲ Mortality ▲ Litigation ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Mortality exposure, 4 per Litigation exposure, and 4 per Health Price exposure.

Overdose deaths rose for two decades, and the lawsuits followed.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 236 / 357